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A. Introducing work

a) Establishing the importance of the topic for the world or society

X is fundamental to ...

X has a pivotal role in ...

X is frequently prescribed for ...

X is fast becoming a key instrument in ...

X plays a vital role in the metabolism of ...

X plays a critical role in the maintenance of ...

Xs have emerged as powerful platforms for ...

X is essential for a wide range of technologies.

X can play an important role in addressing the issue of ...

Xs are the most potent anti-inflammatory agents known.

There is evidence that X plays a crucial role in regulating ...

X is a common condition which has considerable impact on ...

In the new global economy, X has become a central issue for ...

Evidence suggests that X is among the most important factors for ...

X is important for a wide range of scientific and industrial processes.

Xs are one of the most widely used groups of antibacterial agents and ...

There is a growing body of literature that recognises the importance of ...

X is an important component in the climate system, and plays a key role in Y.

In the history of development economics, X has been thought of as a key factor in ...

Xs are one of the most widely used groups of Y and have been extensively used for

b) Establishing the importance of the topic for the discipline

A key aspect of X is ...

X is of interest because ...

X is a classic problem in ...

A primary concern of X is ...

X is a dominant feature of ...

X is an important aspect of ...

X is a fundamental property of ...

The concepts of X and Y are central to ...

X is at the heart of our understanding of ...

Investigating X is a continuing concern within ...

X is a major area of interest within the field of ...

X has been studied by many researchers using ...

X has been an object of research since the 1960s.

X has been the subject of many classic studies in ...

X has been instrumental in our understanding of ...

The theory of X provides a useful account of how ...

Central to the entire discipline of X is the concept of ...

X is an increasingly important area in applied linguistics.

The issue of X has received considerable critical attention.

X has long been a question of great interest in a wide range of fields.

c) Establishing the importance of the topic (time frame given)

Recently, there has been renewed interest in ...

Traditionally, Xs have subscribed to the belief that ...

One of the most important events of the 1970s was ...

In recent years, there has been an increasing interest in ...

Recent developments in X have heightened the need for ...

The last two decades have seen a growing trend towards ...

Recently, researchers have shown an increased interest in ...

Over the past century, there has been a dramatic increase in ...

Recent trends in X have led to a proliferation of studies that ...

X proved an important literary genre in the early Y community.

The past decade has seen the rapid development of X in many ...

Since it was reported in 2005, X has been attracting a lot of interest.

Recently, a considerable literature has grown up around the theme of ...

Recent developments in the field of X have led to a renewed interest in ...

The past thirty years have seen increasingly rapid advances in the field of ...

The changes experienced by X over the past decade remain unprecedented.

In light of recent events in X, it is becoming extremely difficult to ignore the existence of ...

d) Establishing the importance of the topic as a problem to be addressed

X is a major problem in ...

Of particular concern is ...

One of the main obstacles ...

One of the greatest challenges ...

A key issue is the safe disposal of ...

The main disadvantage of X is that ...

X is associated with increased risk of ...

X impacts negatively upon a range of ...

X is a common disorder characterised by ...
 It is now well established that X can impair ...
 X has led to the decline in the population of ...
 X is a growing public health concern worldwide.
 The main challenge faced by many researchers is the ...
 X is one of the most frequently stated problems with ...
 Lack of X has existed as a health problem for many years.
 X is a major environmental problem, and the main cause of ...
 Xs are one of the most rapidly declining groups of insects in ...
 X is the leading cause of death in western-industrialised countries.
 Exposure to X has been shown to be related to adverse effects in ...
 There is increasing concern that some Xs are being disadvantaged ...
 There is an urgent need to address the safety problems caused by ...

However,	X may cause ... X is limited by ... X suffers from ... X is too expensive to be used for ... X has accentuated the problem of ... the performance of X is limited by ... X could be a contributing factor to ... the synthesis of X remains a major challenge. X can be extremely harmful to human beings. research has consistently shown that X lacks ... a major problem with this kind of application is ... the determination of X is technically challenging. current methods of X have proven to be unreliable. these rapid changes are having a serious effect on ... X can be adversely affected under certain conditions. observations have indicated a serious decline in the population of ...
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e) Referring to previous work to establish what is already known

Recent evidence suggests that ...
 Extensive research has shown that ...
 Studies of X show the importance of ...
 It has previously been observed that ...
 Several attempts have been made to ...
 Previous research has established that ...
 Data from several studies suggest that ...
 Recent work by historians has established that ...
 Previous research comparing X and Y has found ...

The existing body of research on X suggests that ...

There is a growing body of literature that recognises ...

Several theories on the origin of X have been proposed.

Existing research recognises the critical role played by ...

It is now well established from a variety of studies, that ...

Recently investigators have examined the effects of X on Y.

Surveys such as that conducted by Smith (1988) have shown that ...

Factors found to be influencing X have been explored in several studies.

A number of cross-sectional studies suggest an association between X and Y...

Studies over the past two decades have provided important information on ...

A considerable amount of literature has been published on X. These studies ...

f) Identifying a controversy within the field of study

A much debated question is whether ...

One major issue in early X research concerned ...

To date there has been little agreement on what ...

The issue has grown in importance in light of recent ...

One of the most significant current discussions in X is ...

In the literature on X, the relative importance of Y is debated.

One observer has already drawn attention to the paradox in ...

Questions have been raised about the use of animal subjects in ...

In many Xs, a debate is taking place between Ys and Zs concerning ...

Debate continues about the best strategies for the management of ...

This concept has recently been challenged by X studies demonstrating ...

The debate about X has gained fresh prominence with many arguing that ...

Scholars have long debated the impact of X on the creation and diffusion of ...

More recently, literature has emerged that offers contradictory findings about ...

One major theoretical issue that has dominated the field for many years concerns ...

The controversy about scientific evidence for X has raged unabated for over a century.

The issue of X has been a controversial and much disputed subject within the field of ...

The causes of X have been the subject of intense debate within the scientific community.

In the literature on X, the relative importance of Y has been subject to considerable discussion.

g) Explaining the inadequacies of previous studies

Previous studies of X have not dealt with ...

Researchers have not treated X in much detail.

Such expositions are unsatisfactory because they ...

Most studies in the field of X have only focused on ...

Such approaches, however, have failed to address ...

Previous published studies are limited to local surveys.
 Half of the studies evaluated failed to specify whether ...
 The research to date has tended to focus on X rather than Y.
 Previously published studies on the effect of X are not consistent.
 Smith's analysis does not take account of ..., nor does she examine ...
 The existing accounts fail to resolve the contradiction between X and Y.
 However, much of the research up to now has been descriptive in nature ...
 The generalisability of much published research on this issue is problematic.
 Research on the subject has been mostly restricted to limited comparisons of ...
 However, few writers have been able to draw on any systematic research into ...
 Short-term studies such as these do not necessarily show subtle changes over time ...
 Although extensive research has been carried out on X, no single study exists which ...
 However, these results were based upon data from over 30 years ago and it is unclear if ...
 The experimental data are rather controversial, and there is no general agreement about ...
 Most studies in X have only been carried out in a small number of areas.

h) Identifying the paucity or lack of previous research

There is little published data on ...
 No previous study has investigated X.
 The use of X has not been investigated.
 There has been no detailed investigation of ...
 There has been little quantitative analysis of ...
 Data about the efficacy and safety of X are limited.
 Up to now, far too little attention has been paid to ...
 A search of the literature revealed few studies which ...
 The impact of X on Y is understudied, particularly for ...
 Few studies have investigated X in any systematic way ...
 In addition, no research has been found that surveyed ...
 So far, however, there has been little discussion about ...
 So far, very little attention has been paid to the role of X.
 Surprisingly, the effects of X have not been closely examined.
 In contrast to X, there is much less information about effects of ...
 A systematic understanding of how X contributes to Y is still lacking.
 Despite the importance of X, there remains a paucity of evidence on ...
 There have been no controlled studies which compare differences in ...
 To date, the problem has received scant attention in the research literature
 To date, there are few studies that have investigated the association between ...

While	some research has	no single study exists which ...
Whilst	been carried out on	no studies have been found which ...

Although	X,	no controlled studies have been reported. only two studies have attempted to investigate ... there have been few empirical investigations into ... there is still very little scientific understanding of ... the mechanism by which ... has not been established.
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i) Identifying a knowledge gap in the field of study

It is still not known whether ...

... much less is known about X.

The nature of X remains unclear.

Currently, there are no data on ...

What is less clear is the nature of ...

Very little is currently known about X in ...

Research to date has not yet determined ...

What is not yet clear is the impact of X on ...

There is still uncertainty, however, whether ...

The response of X to Y is not fully understood.

Causal factors leading to X remain speculative.

The neurobiological basis of X is poorly understood.

Little is known about X and it is not clear what factors ...

To date, only a limited number of Xs have been identified.

The mechanisms that underpin X are not fully understood.

Much uncertainty still exists about the relationship between ...

This indicates a need to understand the various perceptions of X that exist among ...

It is now well established that ... However, the influence of X on Y has remained unclear.

However,	very little is known about X in... few studies have investigated ... the nature of X remains unclear. much less is known about how ... the use of X has not been investigated. far too little attention has been paid to ... the behaviour of X has not yet been investigated. the evidence for this relationship is inconclusive ... much uncertainty still exists about the relation between ... there have been no controlled studies which compare differences in ...
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j) Stating the focus, aim, or argument of a short paper

In this paper, I argue that ...

This paper attempts to show that ...

The central thesis of this paper is that ...

In the pages that follow, it will be argued that ...

In this essay, I attempt to defend the view that ...

The aim of this essay is to explore the relationship between ...

The purpose of this paper is to review recent research into the ...

This paper	argues that ... gives an account of ... discusses the case of ... analyses the impact of ... attempts to show that ... contests the claim that ... provides an overview of ... reviews the evidence for ... reports on a study which ... traces the development of ... explores the ways in which ... assesses the significance of ... highlights the importance of ... considers the implications of ... critically examines the view that ... proposes a new methodology for ... examines the relationship between ... compares the different ways in which ... investigates the factors that determine ... describes the design and implementation of ...
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k) Stating the purpose of the current research

The specific objective of this study was to ...

An objective of this study was to investigate ...

This thesis will examine the way in which the ...

This study set out to investigate the usefulness of ...

This dissertation seeks to explain the development of ...

This case study seeks to examine the changing nature of ...

The objectives of this research are to determine whether ...

This prospective study was designed to investigate the use of ...

This research examines the emerging role of X in the context of ...

This study systematically reviews the data for..., aiming to provide ...

Drawing upon two strands of research into X, this study attempts to ...

This thesis intends to determine the extent to which ... and whether ...
This dissertation aims to unravel some of the mysteries surrounding ...
This study therefore set out to assess the effect of X ..., and the effect of ...
The main aim of this study is to investigate the differences between X and Y.
Part of the aim of this project is to develop software that is compatible with ...
There are two primary aims of this study: 1. To investigate ... 2. To ascertain ...
This study seeks to obtain data which will help to address these research gaps.
One purpose of this study was to assess the extent to which these factors were ...
The purpose of this investigation is to explore the relationship between X and Y.

l) Describing the research design and the methods used

Data for this study were collected using ...
Five works will be examined, all of which ...
This investigation takes the form of a case-study of the ...
This study was exploratory and interpretative in nature.
This study uses a qualitative case study approach to investigate ...
The research data in this thesis is drawn from four main sources: ...
The approach to empirical research adopted for this study was one of ...
This dissertation follows a case-study design, with in-depth analysis of ...
By employing qualitative modes of enquiry, I attempt to illuminate the ...
Qualitative and quantitative research designs were adopted to provide ...
Both qualitative and quantitative methods were used in this investigation.
A holistic approach is utilised, integrating X, Y and Z material to establish ...
The study was conducted in the form of a survey, with data being gathered via ...
The methodological approach taken in this study is a mixed methodology based on ...
A combination of quantitative and qualitative approaches was used in the data analysis.

m) Explaining the significance of the current study

This is the first study to ...
This study provides new insights into ...
This work will generate fresh insight into ...
The study offers some important insights into ...
Understanding the link between X and Y will help ...
This is the first study to undertake a longitudinal analysis of ...
The present research explores, for the first time, the effects of ...
The importance and originality of this study are that it explores ...
The findings should make an important contribution to the field of
Characterisation of X is important for our increased understanding of ...
It is hoped that this research will contribute to a deeper understanding of ...

This study aims to contribute to this growing area of research by exploring ...
This project provided an important opportunity to advance the understanding of ...
Therefore, this study makes a major contribution to research on X by demonstrating ...
There are several important areas where this study makes an original contribution to ...
The experimental work presented here provides one of the first investigations into how ...

n) Describing the limitations of the current study

The thesis does not engage with ...
It is not the task of this paper to examine ...
This study is unable to encompass the entire ...
Establishing X is beyond the scope of this study.
It is beyond the scope of this study to examine the ...
A full discussion of X lies beyond the scope of this study.
The reader should bear in mind that the study is based on ...
Another potential problem is that the scope of my thesis may be too broad.
Due to practical constraints, this paper cannot provide a comprehensive review of...

o) Giving reasons for personal interest in the research

I became interested in Xs after reading ...
My interest in this area developed while I was ...
I have worked closely with X for many years and ...
My personal experience of X has prompted this research.
My main reason for choosing this topic is personal interest.
It is my experience of working with X that has driven this research.
This project was conceived during my time working for X. As a medical advisor, I witnessed ...
* sometimes found in the humanities, and the applied human sciences

p) Outlining the structure of the paper or dissertation

The first section of this paper will examine...
This paper begins by ... It will then go on to ...
My thesis is composed of four themed chapters.
The essay has been organised in the following way.
The remaining part of the paper proceeds as follows: ...
The main issues addressed in this paper are: a), b) and c).
This paper first gives a brief overview of the recent history of X.
This paper has been divided into four parts. The first part deals with ...
The third chapter is concerned with the methodology used for this study.
The overall structure of the study takes the form of six chapters, including ...

Chapter Four analyses the results of interviews and focus group discussions undertaken during ...

Chapter Two begins by laying out the theoretical dimensions of the research, and looks at how ...

The fourth section **presents the findings of the research**, focusing on the three key themes that ...

q) Explaining key terms used in the current work

Throughout this paper, the term 'X' will refer to ...

The term 'X' will be used in this thesis to refer to ...

Historically, the term 'X' has been used to describe ...

It is necessary here to clarify exactly what is meant by ...

The phrase 'X' will be used in this study to describe the ...

According to Smith (2002), X can be defined as follows: ' ... '

In this article, the abbreviation XYZ will be used to refer to ...

Throughout this dissertation, the term 'X' will be used to refer to ...

The term 'X' is a relatively new name for ..., commonly referred to as ...

In this essay, the term 'X' will be used in its broadest sense to refer to all ...

In this dissertation, the terms 'X' and 'Y' are used interchangeably to mean ...

While a variety of definitions of the term X have been suggested, this paper will use the definition first suggested by Smith (1968) who saw it as ...

B. Referring to Sources

a) General comments on the relevant literature

The literature on X has highlighted several ...

Different theories exist in the literature regarding ...

More recent attention has focused on the provision of ...

There are relatively few historical studies in the area of ...

A large and growing body of literature has investigated ...

Much of the literature since the mid-1990s emphasises the ...

Much of the current literature on X pays particular attention to ...

There is a large volume of published studies describing the role of ...

The existing literature on X is extensive and focuses particularly on ...

There is a relatively small body of literature that is concerned with ...

The generalisability of much published research on this issue is problematic.

A considerable amount of literature has been published on X. These studies ...

Previous research findings into X have been inconsistent and contradictory (Smith, 1996; ...).

The academic literature on X has revealed the emergence of several contrasting themes.

b) Previous research: a historical perspective

Research into X has a long history.

For many years, this phenomenon was surprisingly neglected by ...

Only in the past ten years have studies of X directly addressed how ...

Prior to the work of Smith (1983), the role of X was largely unknown.

Over the past decade, most research in X has emphasized the use of ...

In recent years, there has been an increasing amount of literature on ...

Early examples of research into X include ... (Smith, 1962; Jones, 1974).

During the past 30 years, much more information has become available on ...

The first serious discussions and analyses of X emerged during the 1970s with ...

Over the past two decades, major advances in molecular biology have allowed ...

Historically, research investigating the factors associated with X has focused on ...

It is only since the work of Smith (2001) that the study of X has gained momentum.

The construct of X was first articulated by Smith (1977) and popularised in his book: ...

Around the early 1960s, small-scale research and case studies began to emerge linking ...

It was not until the late 1960s that historians considered X worthy of scholarly attention.

Awareness of X is not recent, having possibly first been described in the 5th century BCE by ...

c) Previous research: methodological approaches taken

Most research on X has been carried out in ...

Most researchers investigating X have utilised ...

Using this approach, researchers have been able to ...

Several systematic reviews of X have been undertaken.

The vast majority of studies on X have been quantitative.

What we know about X is largely based on observational studies.

There are a number of large cross-sectional studies which suggest ...

Much of the previous research on X has been exploratory in nature.

Much of the X research has focused on identifying and evaluating the ...

What we know about X is largely based upon empirical studies that investigate how ...

Publications that concentrate on X more frequently adopt a historical or chronological approach ...

d) Previous research: area investigated

To date, several studies have investigated ...

A number of studies have begun to examine ...

Various studies have assessed the efficacy of ...

Researchers attempted to evaluate the impact of ...

A great deal of previous research into X has focused on ...

Several studies have used longitudinal data to examine ...

Previous studies have explored the relationships between X and Y.

Twenty cohort study analyses have examined the relationship between ...

A number of authors have considered the effects of ... (Smith, 2003; Jones, 2004).

At least 120 case-control studies worldwide have examined the relationship between ...

Numerous studies have attempted to explain ... (for example, Smith, 1996; Jones, 1998; ...).

e) Previous research: what has been established or proposed

Several lines of evidence suggest that ...

Previous research has established that ...

Data from several studies suggest that ...

It is now well established from a variety of studies that ...

A number of studies have postulated a convergence between ...

Surveys such as that conducted by Smith (1988) have shown that ...

Many recent studies (e.g. Smith, 2001; Jones, 2005) have shown that ...

Traditionally, it has been argued that ... (e.g. Smith, 1960; Jones, 1972).

Several biographies of Brown have been published. Smith (2013) presents ...

In previous studies on X, different variables have been found to be related to ...

Many historians have argued that ... (e.g. Jones, 1987; Johnson, 1990; Smith, 1994).

There is a consensus among social scientists that ... (e.g. Jones, 1987; Johnson, 1990; ...

Data from several sources have identified the increased X and Y associated with obesity.

It has been demonstrated that a high intake of X results in damage to ... (Smith, 1998; ...).

There is a large number of published studies (e.g., Smith, 2001; Jones, 2005) that describe ...

Some cross-sectional studies suggest an association between X and Y (Smith, 2004; Jones, 2005).

It has been suggested that levels of X are independent of the size of the Y (Smith et al., 1995).

It has conclusively been shown that X and Y increase Z (Smith et al., 1999; Jones, 2001 ...).

To date, Thus far, Up to now,	several studies previous studies a number of studies	have	used ... found ... reported ... shown that... indicated that ... linked X with Y. suggested that ... demonstrated that ... begun to examine the use of ... confirmed the effectiveness of ... revealed a correlation between X and Y. highlighted factors that are associated with ...
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f) Stating what is currently known about the topic

X, Y and Z appear to be closely linked (Smith, 2008).

X appears to be positively related to both Y and Z (Smith, 2007)

X is a principal determining factor of Y (Smith, 2005; Jones, 2013).

X is one of the most intense reactions following CHD (Lane, 2003).

There is an unambiguous relationship between X and Y (Rao, 1998).

X is significantly reduced during the first months of ... (Smith, 2000; Jones, 2006).

X has been found to oppose the anti-inflammatory actions of Y on Z (Alourfi, 2004).

GM varieties of maize are able to cross-pollinate with non-GM varieties (Smith, 1998; O'Brien, ...

A relationship exists between an individual's working memory and their ability to ... (Jones, 2002).

g) Reference to a previous investigation: researcher prominent

Smith (1999)	showed that reducing X to 190oC decreased ... (see Figure 2). demonstrated that when the maximum temperature is exceeded ... found that as levels of literacy and education of the population rise ...
Jones et al. (2001)	compared the rate of ... labelled these subsets as ...

	measured both components of the ... used a survey to assess the various ... identified parents of disabled children as ... set up a series of virtual experiments using ... examined the flow of international students ... carried out a number of investigations into the ... studied the effects of X on unprotected nerve cells. analysed the data from 72 countries and concluded that ... interviewed 250 undergraduate students using semi-structured ... performed a similar series of experiments in the 1960s to show that ... reviewed the literature from the period and found little evidence for this ... conducted a series of trials in which he mixed X with different quantities of ... investigated the differential impact of formal and non-formal education on ...
--	---

h) Reference to a previous investigation: time prominent

In 1959, a seminal article was published entitled ...

In 1889, Brown performed a bilateral ablation of the ...

In 1859, the publication of X had a major impact on ...

In 1965, Jones published his major historic survey of ...

In 1975, Smith et al. published a paper in which they described ...

In 1984, Jones et al. made several amino acid esters of X and evaluated them as ...

In 1981, Smith and co-workers demonstrated that X induced in vitro resistance to ...

In 1990, Patel et al. demonstrated that replacement of H₂O with heavy water led to ...

In 1990, Al-Masry et al. reported a new and convenient synthetic procedure to obtain ...

Thirty years later, Smith (1974) reported three cases of X which ...

In the 1950s, Gunnar Myrdal pointed to some of the ways in which ...

Following World War 1, Fleming actively searched for anti-bacterial agents.

Almost 20 years ago, Jones (1985) formulated his X theory, centred around ...

i) Reference to a previous investigation: investigation prominent

One longitudinal study found that ...

A seminal study in this area is the work of ...

One study by Smith (2014) examined the trend in ...

A recent study by Smith and Jones (2012) involved ...

A qualitative study by Smith (2003) described how ...

A recent systematic literature review concluded that ...

Preliminary work on X was undertaken by Jones (1992).

A longitudinal study of X by Smith (2012) reports that ...

A key study comparing X and Y is that of Smith (2010), in which ...
The first systematic study of X was reported by Smith et al. in 1986.
Detailed examination of X by Smith and Jones (1961) showed that ...
Analysis of the genes involved in X was first carried out by Smith et al. (1983).
A significant analysis and discussion on the subject was presented by Smith (1988).
The study of the structural behaviour of X was first carried out by Jones et al. (1986).
A small scale study by Smith (2012) reached different conclusions, finding no increase in ...
The study by Jones (1990) offers probably the most comprehensive empirical analysis of ...
In an analysis of X, Smith et al. (2012) found ...
In a follow-up study, Smith et al. (2009) found that ...
In an investigation into X, Smith et al. (2012) found ...
In a study investigating X, Smith (2004) reported that ...
In a comprehensive study of X, Jones (2001) found that ...
In a study conducted by Smith (1978), it was shown that ...
In studies of rats given X, Smith and colleagues found that ...
In a study which set out to determine X, Smith (2012) found that ...
In a randomised controlled study of X, Smith (2012) reported that ...
In another major study, Smith (1974) found that just over half of the ...
In a recent cross-sectional study, Smith (2006b) investigated whether ...
In a large longitudinal study, Smith et al. (2012) investigated the incidence of X in Y.
In one well-known recent experiment, limits on X were found to be ... (Smith, 2013)

j) Reference to a previous investigation: topic prominent

To determine the effects of X, Jones et al. (2005) compared ...
X was originally isolated from Y in a soil sample from ... (Jones et al., 1952).
The electronic spectroscopy of X was first studied by Smith and Jones in 1970.
X formed the central focus of a study by Smith (2002) in which the author found ...
To better understand the mechanisms of X and its effects, Jones (2013) analysed the ...
X was first demonstrated experimentally by Pavlov (Smith, 2002). In his seminal study ...
The acid-catalyzed condensation reaction between X and Y was first reported by Smith in 1872.
The way in which X is regulated was studied extensively by Smith and colleagues (Smith et al. 1995 and 1998).

k) Reference to what other writers do in their text

In Chapter 2, Smith provides us with a number of important ...
In the subsequent chapter, Smith examines the extent to which ...
By drawing on the concept of X, Smith has been able to show that ...
Some analysts (e.g. Carnoy, 2002) have attempted to draw fine distinctions between ...
Drawing on an extensive range of sources, the authors set out the different ways in which ...
Other authors (see Harbison, 2003; Kaplan, 2004) question the usefulness of such an approach.

Smith (2000)	identifies X, Y, and Z as the major causes of ... draws on an extensive range of sources to assess ... highlights the need to break the link between X and Y. uses examples of these various techniques as evidence that ... mentions the special situation of Singapore as an example of ... questions whether mainstream schools are the best environment for ... draws our attention to distinctive categories of X often observed in ... considers whether countries work well on cross-border issues such as ... discusses the challenges and strategies for facilitating and promoting ... provides in-depth analysis of the work of Aristotle showing its relevance to ... defines evidence based medicine as the conscious, explicit and judicious use of ... lists three reasons why the English language has become so dominant. These are: ... traces the development of Japanese history and philosophy during the 19th century.		
In her review of ..., In her major study, In her analysis of ..., In her case study of ..., In her introduction to ..., In her seminal article, In her classic critique of ..., In her interesting analysis of ...,	Smith (2012) identifies five characteristics of ...		

l) Reference to another writer's idea or position

According to Smith (2003), preventative medicine is far more cost effective, and therefore ...

As noted by Smith (2003) X is far more cost effective, and therefore ...

Smith (2013)	argues claims suggests maintains concludes points out	that	preventative medicine is far more cost effective, and therefore better adapted to the developing world.
	offers proposes suggests argues for		an explanatory theory for each type of irrational belief.

m) Synthesising material: bringing sources together

Similarly, Nicoladis (2006) found that X ...

In the same vein, Smith (1994) in his book XYZ notes ...

This view is supported by Jones (2000) who writes that ...

Smith argues that her data support O'Brien's (1988) view that ...

Al-Masry's (1986) work on X is complemented by Smith's (2009) study of ...

Almost every paper that has been written on X includes a section relating to ...

Unlike Smith, Jones (2013) argues that ...

In contrast to Smith, Jones (2013) argues that ...

A broader perspective has been adopted by Smith (2013) who argues that ...

Conversely, Wang (2010) reported no significant difference in mortality between X and Y.

Smith argues that ...	Similarly, Jones (2013) asserts that ...
Al-Masry (2003) sees X as ...	Likewise, Wang (2012) holds the view that ...
Some writers (e.g. Smith, 2002) have attempted to draw fine distinctions between ...	Others (see Jones, 2003; Brown, 2004) question the usefulness of ...
Some authors have mainly been interested in questions concerning X and Y (Smith, 2001; Jones ...	Others have highlighted the relevance of ...
Much of the available literature on X deals with the question of ...	But Smith (2008) is much more concerned with ...
Zhao (2002) notes that ...	However, Jennings' (2010) study of Y found no link between ...
Smith (2013) found that X accounted for 30% of Y.	Other researchers, however, who have looked at X, have found ...
	Jones (2010), for example, ...
Smith (2010) presents an X account,	whilst Jones (2011) ...
While Smith (2008) focusses on X,	Jones (2009) is more concerned with ...

Some ways of introducing quotations

Commenting on X, Smith (2003) argues: '... ..'

As Carnoy (2004: 215) states: 'there are many good reasons to be sceptical'.

As Smith argues: 'In the past, the purpose of education was to ...' (Smith, 2000:150).

In the final part of the Theses on Feuerbach, Marx writes: 'Philosophers have hitherto only ...'

Sachs concludes: 'The idea of development stands today like a ruin in ...' (Sachs, 1992a: 156).

As Smith (2013: 320)	notes: '... .. ' argues '... .. ' writes: '... .. ' observes: '... .. ' points out: '... .. ' reminds us: '... .. '
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n) Summarising the review or parts of the review

Together, these studies indicate that ...

Overall, these studies highlight the need for ...

Considering all of this evidence, it seems that ...

Collectively, these studies outline a critical role for...

In all the studies reviewed here, X is recognised as ...

The evidence presented in this section suggests that ...

The studies presented thus far provide evidence that ...

Taken together, these studies support the notion that ...

Overall, there seems to be some evidence to indicate that ...

Together these studies provide important insights into the ...

All of the studies reviewed here support the hypothesis that ...

Two important themes emerge from the studies discussed so far:

However, such studies remain narrow in focus dealing only with ...

The evidence reviewed here seems to suggest a pertinent role for ...

These studies clearly indicate that there is a relationship between ...

In view of all that has been mentioned so far, one may suppose that ...

There remain several aspects of X about which relatively little is known.

C. Describing Methods

a) Describing previously used research methods

Many researchers have utilised X to measure ...
One of the most well-known tools for assessing ...
Traditionally, X has been assessed by measuring ...
A number of techniques have been developed to ...
Different methods have been proposed to classify ...
X is the main non-invasive method used to determine ...
Different authors have measured X in a variety of ways.
Several methods currently exist for the measurement of X.
Previous studies have based their criteria for selection on ...
X is one of the most common procedures for determining ...
There are three main types of study design used to identify ...
The use of life story data has a relatively long tradition within X.
Recent advances in X methods have facilitated investigation of ...
There are a number of instruments available for measuring the ...
X and Y are currently the most popular methods for investigating ...
Recently, simpler and more rapid tests of X have been developed.
In most recent studies, X has been measured in four different ways.
The use of qualitative case studies is a well-established approach in ...
Xs have been used in the past to investigate the mechanical properties of ...

b) Giving reasons why a method was adopted or rejected

A major advantage of X is that ...
The benefit of this approach is that ...
X based methods provide a means of ...
X was selected for its reliability and validity.
A case study approach was used to allow a ...
This method is particularly useful in studying ...
A quantitative approach was employed since ...
Qualitative methods offer an effective way of ...
The design of the questionnaires was based on ...
The X method is one of the more practical ways of ...
The semi-structured approach was chosen because ...
The X approach has a number of attractive features: ...
The advantages of Xs are that they are simple to deliver.
The second advantage of using the multivariate method is ...

The study uses qualitative analysis in order to gain insights into ...

One advantage of the X analysis is that it avoids the problem of ...

Another advantage of using computer simulations is that it allows ...

Continuous sampling methods have a number of advantages over ...

The collaborative nature of the focus group offers another advantage ...

Qualitative methods can be more useful for identifying and characterising ...

A major problem with the experimental method is that ...

The main disadvantage of the experimental method is that ...

However, there are certain drawbacks associated with the use of ...

There are certain problems with the use of focus groups. One of these is that there is less ...

A case-study approach was	used chosen adopted	to ensure that ... to help understand how ... to allow a deeper insight into ... to conduct this exploratory study. to evaluate the effectiveness of ... to determine the factors that affect ... to gain a detailed understanding of ... to assess the management practices of ... to obtain further in-depth information on the ... to provide rounded, detailed illustrations of the ... to capture the complexities of the phenomenon.
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c) Indicating the use of an established method

The solution was then assayed for X using the Y method.

X was prepared according to the procedure used by Jones et al. (1957).

The synthesis of X was done according to the procedure of Smith (1973).

X was synthesised using the same method that was detailed for Y, using ...

Samples were analysed for X as previously reported by Smith et al. (2012).

Analysis was based on the conceptual framework proposed by Smith et al. (2002).

This compound was prepared by adapting the procedure used by Jones et al. (1990)...

d) Describing the characteristics of the sample

The cohort was divided into two groups according to ...

A random sample of patients with ... was recruited from ...

Articles were searched from January 1965 until April 2014.

The sample was representative with respect to gender and ...

Forty-seven students studying X were recruited for this study.

A systematic literature review was conducted of studies that ...

Just over half the sample (53%) was female, of whom 69% were ...

Of the initial cohort of 123 students, 66 were female and 57 male.

Eligible women who matched the selection criteria were identified by ...

Only children aged between 10 and 15 years were included in the study.

The participants were divided into two groups based on their performance on ...

Two groups of subjects were interviewed, namely X and Y. The first group were ...

The project used a convenience sample of 32 first year modern languages students.

All of the participants were aged between 18 and 19 at the beginning of the study...

All studies described as using some sort of X procedure were included in the analysis.

Participants were recruited from 15 clinics across ..., covering urban and rural areas ...

The initial sample consisted of 200 students, 75 of whom belonged to minority groups.

Semi-structured interviews were conducted with 17 male offenders with a mean age of 38 years.

e) Indicating criteria for selection or inclusion

Criteria for selecting the subjects were as follows:

Publications were only included in the analysis if...

The participants in this study were recruited from ...

To identify X, the following parameters were used: ...

The area of study was chosen for its relatively small ...

Primary inclusion criteria for the X participants were ...

Eligibility criteria required individuals to have received ...

Five individuals were excluded from the study on the basis of ...

A small sample was chosen because of the expected difficulty in obtaining ...

The subjects were selected on the basis of the degree of homogeneity of their ...

A comparison group of 12 male subjects without any history of X was drawn from a pool of ...

f) Describing the process: infinitive of purpose

In order to identify ..., the participants were asked to ...

In order to understand how X regulates Y, a series of transfections was performed.

To establish whether ...,

To measure X, a question asking ... was used.

To determine whether ..., the cells were incubated for ...

To rule out the possibility that X, the participants were ...

To control for bias, measurements were carried out by another person.

To assess whether and how Xs are produced and received, we measured ...

To see if the two methods gave the same measurement, the data was plotted and ...

To enable the subjects to see the computer screen clearly, the laptop was configured with ...

To increase the reliability of measures, each X was tested twice with a 4-minute break between ...

To compare the scores three weeks after initial screening, a global ANOVA F-test was used

The vials were capped with ... to prevent ...

The process was repeated several times in order to remove ...

In an attempt to make each interviewee feel as comfortable as possible, the interviewer ...

g) Describing the process: expressing purpose with 'for'

For the attitude questions, a Likert scale was used.

For the purpose of height measurement, subjects were asked to stand ...

For the purpose of analysis, two segments were extracted from each ...

For the estimation of protein concentration, 100 µL of protein sample was mixed with ...

h) Describing the process: verbs used in the passive

All participants were sent ...

The data were normalised using ...

Ethical approval was obtained from ...

Drugs were administered by icv injection ...

Descriptive data were generated for all variables.

The procedures of this study were approved by ...

Prompts were used as an aid to question two so that ...

Data were collected using semi-structured interviews in ...

Participants were thanked for their time and effort and for ...

The experiments were run using custom software written in...

Two sets of anonymised questionnaires were completed by ...

A total of 256 samples were taken from 52 boreholes (Figure 11).

The solution was washed three times with deionized water and ...

Significance levels were set at the 1% level using the student t-test.

Data management and analysis were performed using SPSS 16.0 (2010).

Published studies were identified using a search strategy developed in ...

Data were gathered from multiple sources at various time points during ...

Injection solutions were coded by a colleague to reduce experimenter bias.

The pilot interviews were conducted informally by the trained interviewer ...

Article references were searched further for additional relevant publications...

i) Describing the process: sequence words

To begin this process, ...

The first step in this process was to ...

The second method used to identify X involved ...

The subjects were then shown a film individually and were asked to ...

The soil was then weighed again, and this weight was recorded as ...

The results were corrected for the background readings and then averaged before ...

These ratings were then made for the ten stimuli to which the subject had been exposed ...

The analysis was checked when initially performed and then checked again at the end of ...

Finally, questions were asked as to the role of ...

In the follow-up phase of the study, participants were asked ...

The final stage of the study comprised a semi-structured interview with participants who ...

Prior to	commencing the study, ethical clearance was sought from ... analysing the interview data, the transcripts were checked for ... data collection, the participants received an explanation of the project. undertaking the investigation, ethical clearance was obtained from ...
After	'training', the participants were told that ... collection, the samples were shipped back to X in ... testing for the presence of antibodies, the blood was ... the appliance was fitted, the patients attended X every four weeks.
On	arrival at the clinic, patients were asked to ... completion of X, the process of parameter estimation was carried out obtaining written informed consent from the patients, a questionnaire was ...
Once	the samples were extracted, it was first necessary to ... the Xs were located and marked, a thin clear plastic ruler ... the exposures were completed, the X was removed from the Y and placed in ... the positions had been decided upon, the Xs were removed from each Y and ...
Following	correction for ..., X was reduced to ... conformational analysis of X, it was necessary to ... administration of X to patients, we assessed the effects on ... this treatment, the samples were recovered and stored overnight.
When	dividing X, care was taken to ... removing X, it was important to ... inviting the participants, the purpose of the research was clearly explained.

j) Describing the process: adverbs of manner

The medium was then aseptically transferred to a conical flask.

A sample of the concentrate was then carefully injected into ...

The tubes were accurately reweighed to six decimal places using ...

The soil was then placed in a furnace and gradually heated up to ...

The vials were shaken manually to allow the soil to mix well with the water.

The resulting solution was gently mixed at room temperature for ten minutes and ...

k) Describing the process: 'using' + instruments

Data were collected using two high spectral resolution Xs.

Semi-automated genotyping was carried out using X software and ...

Using the X-ray and looking at the actual X, it was possible to identify ...

Comparisons between the two groups were made using unrelated t-tests.

The data were recorded on a digital audio recorder and transcribed using a ...

Statistical significance was analysed using analysis of variance and t-tests as appropriate.

Using an Anthos Micro plate Reader, we were able to separate single cells into different ...

15 subjects were recruited using email advertisements requesting healthy students from ...

All the work on the computer was carried out using Quattro Pro for Windows and ...

l) Describing the process: questionnaire design

The first question elicited information on ...

Seven questions, adapted from X, assessed ...

All survey questions utilised a 5-point Likert scale.

Using a 5-point Likert scale, participants were asked ...

A short questionnaire was designed to ascertain the participants' ...

The questionnaire was designed to measure the following constructs:

Participants were asked to respond using a 5-point Likert scale ranging from ...

The questions asked participants to rate how strongly they agreed with each statement.

The study began with two open-ended survey questions that asked participants to indicate ...

The questionnaire asked participants to complete three open-ended questions that asked about ...

		find out ...
		gauge how much...
		ascertain whether ...
The first question	was designed to	identify the types of ...
		test participants' knowledge of ...
		measure the students' ability to explain ...
		elicit a simple answer to a complex question about ...

m) Describing the process: statistical procedures

The data were normalised using ...

A p value Descriptive data were generated for all variables.

Reliability was calculated using Cronbach's alpha.

All analyses were carried out using SPSS, version 20.

Statistical analysis was performed using SPSS software (version 20).

Significance levels were set at the 1% level using the student t-test.

Data management and analysis were performed using SPSS 16.0 (2010).

The mean score for the two trials was subjected to multivariate analysis of variance to ...

n) Indicating methodological problems or limitations

In particular, the analysis of X was problematic.

In observational studies, there is a potential for bias from ...

The small size of the dataset meant that it was not possible to ...

Further data collection is required to determine exactly how X affects Y.

Another major source of uncertainty is in the method used to calculate X.

In this investigation there are several sources for error. The main error is ...

It was not possible to investigate the significant relationships of X and Y further because...

The responses relating to X were subjective and were therefore susceptible to recall bias.

D. Reporting Results

a) Referring back to the research aims or procedures

The first set of questions aimed to ...

To compare the difference between ...

The purpose of Experiment 3 was to ...

Simple statistical analysis was used to ...

The next question asked the informants ...

To assess X, the Y questionnaire was used.

Changes in X and Y were compared using ...

Regression analysis was used to predict the ...

To distinguish between these two possibilities, ...

The first set of analyses examined the impact of ...

The correlation between X and Y was tested using ...

T-tests were used to analyse the relationship between ...

The average scores of X and Y were compared in order to ...

In order to assess Z, repeated-measures ANOVAs were used.

Nine items on the questionnaire measured the extent to which ...

b) Referring to data in a table or chart

Table 1 Figure 1	shows compares presents provides	an overview of ... the experimental data on X. the summary statistics for ... the breakdown of X according to ... the intercorrelations among the nine measures of X. the results obtained from the preliminary analysis of X.
The table below illustrates The pie chart above shows The top half of the table shows The bottom half of the table shows	some of the main characteristics of the ... the breakdown of ...	
As shown in Figure 1, As can be seen from the table (above), From the graph above we can see that It can be seen from the data in Table 1 that	the X group reported significantly more Y than the other two groups.	
The results of the correlational analysis The themes identified in these responses The results obtained from the preliminary analysis of X	are shown are set out are presented can be compared	in Table 1. in Figure 1.

c) Highlighting significant data in a table or chart

What stands out in the table is ...

Closer inspection of the table shows ...

It is apparent from this table that very few ...

The most interesting aspect of this graph is ...

In Fig.10 there is a clear trend of decreasing ...

What is striking about the figures in this table is ...

What is interesting about the data in this table is that ...

The differences between X and Y are highlighted in Table 4.

From the chart, it can be seen that by far the greatest demand is for ...

From this data, we can see that Study 2 resulted in the lowest value of ...

This table is quite revealing in several ways. First, unlike the other tables ...

From the data in Figure 9, it is apparent that the length of time left between ...

Data from this table can be compared with the data in Table 4.6 which shows ...

As Table III shows, there is a significant difference ($t = -2.15$, $p = 0.03$) between the two groups.

d) Stating a positive result

The mean score for X was ...

Further analysis showed that ...

Further statistical tests revealed ...

A two-way ANOVA revealed that ...

On average, Xs were shown to have ...

Strong evidence of X was found when ...

This result is significant at the $p = 0.05$ level.

The results, as shown in Table 1, indicate that ...

A positive correlation was found between X and Y.

There was a significant positive correlation between ...

The difference between the X and Y groups was significant.

There was a significant difference in X, $t(11) = 2.906$, $p < 0.01$

There was a significant difference between the two conditions ...

Respondents who reported low levels of X also reported significantly lower levels of Y.

e) Stating a negative result

No increase in X was detected.

No difference greater than X was observed.

No significant differences were found between ...

None of these differences were statistically significant.

No significant difference between the two groups was evident.

No significant reduction in X was found compared with placebo.

No evidence was found for non-linear associations between X and Y.

No significant correlation was found between X scores and the Y scores ($p = .274$)

X appeared to be unaffected by Y.

Only trace amounts of X were detected in ...

There was no evidence that X has an influence on ...

The Chi-square test did not show any significant differences between ...

Overall, X did not affect males and females differently in these measures.

A clear benefit of X in the prevention of Y could not be identified in this analysis.

T-tests found no significant differences in mean scores on the X and Y subscales.

f) Reporting positive and negative reactions

Stimulation of X cells with Y did not increase the ...

With successive increases in intensity of the X, the Y moved further to ...

Following the addition of X, a significant increase ($P < 0.05$) in the Y was recorded.

When X cells were stimulated with Y, no significant difference in the number of Z was detected.

g) Highlighting interesting or surprising results

Interestingly, the X was observed to ...

This result is somewhat counterintuitive.

Interestingly, this correlation is related to ...

The more surprising correlation is with the ...

Surprisingly, only a minority of respondents ...

The most surprising aspect of the data is in the ...

The correlation between X and Y is interesting because ...

The most striking result to emerge from the data is that ...

Interestingly, there were also differences in the ratios of ...

The single most striking observation to emerge from the data comparison was ...

This is a/an (rather)	surprising significant interesting remarkable unexpected disappointing	result. outcome.
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h) Surveys and interviews: Reporting response rates

The overall response to the survey was poor.

Thirty-two individuals returned the questionnaires.

The response rate was 60% at six months and 56% at 12 months.

Of the study population, 90 subjects completed and returned the questionnaire.

Of 150 patients who were sent invitations, 81 returned the reply slip, of whom 60 agreed to ...

By the end of the survey period, data had been collected from 64 individuals, 23 of whom were ...

There were 53 responses to the question: '...?'

Respondents were asked to indicate whether ...

The total number of responses for this question was ...

The overall response to this question was very positive.

Respondents were asked to suggest other reasons for ...

In response to the question: '...?', a range of responses was elicited.

This section of the questionnaire required respondents to give information on ...

i) Surveys and interviews: Reporting proportions

Over half of those surveyed reported that ...

A minority of participants (17%) indicated that ...

70% of those who were interviewed indicated that

Almost two-thirds of the participants (64%) said that

The majority of those who responded to this item felt that ...

When asked whether ..., 90% of the respondents reported that ...

Just over half of those who answered this question reported that ...

In response to Question 1, most of those surveyed indicated that ...

When the participants were asked, the majority commented that ...

Of the 148 patients who completed the questionnaire, just over half indicated that ...

j) Surveys and interviews: Reporting themes

Another reported problem was ...

Opinions differed as to whether ...

Concerns were expressed about ...

A number of issues were identified ...

A variety of perspectives were expressed ...

These views surfaced mainly in relation to ...

Concerns regarding X were more widespread.

There was a sense of X amongst interviewees.

Five broad themes emerged from the analysis.

A common view amongst interviewees was that ...
 One concern expressed regarding X was whether ...
 This theme came up for example in discussions of ...
 The themes of X and Y recurred throughout the dataset.
 Two divergent and often conflicting discourses emerged ...
 Two discrete reasons emerged from this. First ... Second ...
 Issues related to X were not particularly prominent in the interview data.
 A recurrent theme in the interviews was a sense amongst interviewees that ...

k) Surveys and interviews: Reporting participants' views

It was suggested that ...
 One interviewee argued that ...
 There were some suggestions that ...
 In all cases, the informants reported that ...
 In their accounts of the events surrounding ...
 There were some negative comments about ...
 The participants on the whole demonstrated ...
 Some felt that ... , while others considered that ...
 Some interviewees argued that ... , while others ...
 This view was echoed by another informant who ..
 Whilst a minority mentioned that..., all agreed that...
 Only a small number of respondents indicated that ...
 A small number of those interviewed suggested that
 For a small number of participants X was the reason for ...
 The majority of participants agreed with the statement that ...
 When asked about X, the participants were unanimous in the view that ...

l) Surveys and interviews: Introducing excerpts

As one interviewee said: '...'
 As one interviewee put it: '...'
 One informant reported that ...
 The comment below illustrates ...
 One participant commented: '...'
 For example, one interviewee said: '...'
 In one case, the participant thought that ...
 Another interviewee, when asked ..., said: '...'
 Other responses to this question included: '...'
 Another interviewee alluded to the notion of ...
 Talking about this issue an interviewee said: '...'

Commenting on X, one of the interviewees said ...

One individual stated that '...' And another commented '...'

m) Transition: moving to the next result

If we now turn to ...

A comparison of the two results reveals ...

Turning now to the experimental evidence on ...

Comparing the two results, it can be seen that ...

The next section of the survey was concerned with ...

In the final part of the survey, respondents were asked ...

n) Summarising the results section

These results suggest that ...

Overall, these results indicate that ...

In summary, these results show that ...

In summary, for the informants in this study, ...

Together these results provide important insights into ...

Taken together, these results suggest that there is an association between ...

The results in this chapter indicate that ... The next chapter, therefore, moves on to discuss the ...

E. Discussing Findings

a) Providing background information: reference to the literature

Several reports have shown that ...

As mentioned in the literature review, ...

Prior studies that have noted the importance of ...

Very little was found in the literature on the question of ...

Previous studies evaluating X observed inconsistent results on whether ...

A strong relationship between X and Y has been reported in the literature.

In reviewing the literature, no data was found on the association between X and Y.

b) Providing background information: reference to the question

The third question in this research was ...

An initial objective of the project was to identify ...

The first question in this study sought to determine ...

It was hypothesised that participants with a history of ...

The present study was designed to determine the effect of ...

With respect to the first research question, it was found that ...

This study set out with the aim of assessing the importance of X in ...

c) Restating the result or one of several results

One interesting finding is ...

The current study found that ...

Another important finding was that ...

The most interesting finding was that ...

In this study, Xs were found to cause ...

The results of this study show/indicate that ...

On the question of X, this study found that ...

This experiment did not detect any evidence for ...

The most important clinically relevant finding was ...

X provided the largest set of significant clusters of ...

It is interesting to note that in all seven cases of this study ...

The most obvious finding to emerge from the analysis is that ...

In the current study, comparing X with Y showed that the mean degree of ...

The results of this study did not show that .../did not show any significant increase in ...

d) Indicating an unexpected outcome

Surprisingly, X was found to ...

What is surprising is that

One unanticipated finding was that

Surprisingly, no differences were found in

This finding was unexpected and suggests that

It is somewhat surprising that no X was noted in this condition

Contrary to expectations, this study did not find a significant difference between

However, the observed difference between X and Y in this study was not significant.

However, the ANOVA (one way) showed that these results were not statistically significant.

e) Comparing the result: supporting previous findings

This study confirms that X is associated with ...

This finding was also reported by Smith et al. (1989).

This finding is consistent with that of Smith (2000) who ...

Comparison of the findings with those of other studies confirms ...

This also accords with our earlier observations, which showed that ...

These results reflect those of Smith et al. (1992) who also found that ...

Increased activation in the X in this study corroborates these earlier findings.

These results corroborate the findings of a great deal of the previous work in ...

This finding broadly supports the work of other studies in this area linking X with Y.

In accordance with the present results, previous studies have demonstrated that ...

It is encouraging to compare this figure with that found by Jones (1993) who found that ...

Consistent with the literature, this research found that participants who reported using X also ...

This study supports evidence from previous observations (e.g. Smith, 2006; Jones et al., 2011).

There are similarities between the attitudes expressed by X in this study and those described by ...

These results	further support the idea of ... confirm the association between ... are consistent with data obtained in ... match those observed in earlier studies. are in line with those of previous studies. are in agreement with those obtained by ... are in accord with recent studies indicating that ... seem to be consistent with other research which found ... are consistent with those of Smith and Jones (2015) who ... are in agreement with Smith's (1999) findings which showed ... support previous research into this brain area which links X and Y. corroborate the ideas of Smith and Jones (2008), who suggested that ...
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f) Comparing the result: contradicting previous findings

This study has been unable to demonstrate that ...

However, this result has not previously been described.

This outcome is contrary to that of Smith et al. (2001) who found ...

This finding is contrary to previous studies which have suggested that ...

In contrast to earlier findings, however, no evidence of X was detected.

The yields in this investigation were higher compared to those of other studies.

However, the findings of the current study do not support the previous research.

Smith et al. (1999) showed that ... This differs from the findings presented here ...

The overall level was found to be 15%, lower than that of previously reported levels.

It has been suggested that ... (Smith et al., 2002). This does not appear to be the case.

The levels observed in this investigation are far below those observed by Smith et al. (2007).

These results differ from X's 2003 estimate of Y, but they are broadly consistent with earlier ...

g) Offering an explanation for the findings

A possible explanation for this might be that ...

Another possible explanation for this is that ...

This result may be explained by the fact that ...

There are, however, other possible explanations.

These relationships may partly be explained by ...

There are several possible explanations for this result.

A possible explanation for these results may be the lack of adequate ...

These differences can be explained in part by the proximity of X and Y.

These factors may explain the relatively good correlation between X and Y.

This inconsistency may be due to ...

These results are likely to be related to ...

This discrepancy could be attributed to ...

It seems possible that these results are due to ...

This rather contradictory result may be due to ...

The observed increase in X could be attributed to ...

It is difficult to explain this result, but it might be related to ...

The possible interference of X cannot be ruled out.

It may be that these participants benefitted from ...

Differences between X and Y may have influenced ...

These possible sources of error could have affected ...

There are two likely causes for the differences between ...

The reason for this is not clear but it may have something to do with ...

The observed correlation between X and Y might be explained in this way: ...

Since this difference has not been found elsewhere it is probably not due to ...

h) Advising cautious interpretation of the findings

Another source of uncertainty is ...

A note of caution is due here since ...

These findings may be somewhat limited by ...

These findings cannot be extrapolated to all patients.

These data must be interpreted with caution because ...

It could be argued that the positive results were due to ...

These results therefore need to be interpreted with caution.

In observational studies, there is a potential for bias from ...

It is important to bear in mind the possible bias in these responses.

Although exclusion of X did not ..., these results should be interpreted with caution.

However, with a small sample size, caution must be applied, as the findings might not be ...

i) Suggesting general hypotheses

It is possible, therefore, that ...

It can thus be suggested that ...

In general, therefore, it seems that ...

It may be the case therefore that these variations ...

It is therefore likely that such connections exist between ...

It is possible to hypothesise that these conditions are less likely to occur in ...

These findings suggest that ...

According to these data, we can infer that ...

This observation may support the hypothesis that ...

Hence, it could conceivably be hypothesised that ...

The value of X suggests that a weak link may exist between ...

These results provide further support for the hypothesis that ...

Therefore, X could be a major factor, if not the only one, causing ...

j) Noting implications of the findings

It can therefore be assumed that the ...

An implication of this is the possibility that ...

The present study raises the possibility that ...

One of the issues that emerges from these findings is ...

Some of the issues emerging from this finding relate specifically to ...

These findings may help us to understand ...

This finding, while preliminary, suggests that

This finding has important implications for developing ...

This observational study suggests that a diet rich in X may help prevent ...

These findings raise intriguing questions regarding the nature and extent of ...

This combination of findings provides some support for the conceptual premise that ...

k) Commenting on the findings

These findings are rather disappointing.

However, these results were not very encouraging.

The test was successful as it was able to identify students who ...

The present results are significant in at least two major respects.

The results of this study do not explain the occurrence of these adverse events.

These findings will doubtless be much scrutinised, but there are some immediately dependable conclusions for ...

l) Giving suggestions for future work

This is an important issue for future research.

Research questions that could be asked include ...

There are still many unanswered questions about ...

Several questions remain unanswered at present.

Despite these promising results, questions remain.

Further work is required to establish the viability of...

Further research should be undertaken to investigate the ...

There is abundant room for further progress in determining ...

A further study with more focus on X is therefore suggested.

Future studies on the current topic are therefore recommended.

To develop a full picture of X, additional studies will be needed that ...

In future investigations, it might be possible to use a different X in which ...

Further studies, which take these variables into account, will need to be undertaken.

F. Writing Conclusions

a) Restating the aims of the study

This study set out to ...

This paper has argued that ...

This essay has discussed the reasons for ...

In this investigation, the aim was to assess ...

The aim of the present research was to examine ...

The purpose of the current study was to determine ...

The main goal of the current study was to determine ...

This project was undertaken to design ... and evaluate ...

The present study was designed to determine the effect of ...

The second aim of this study was to investigate the effects of ...

b) Summarising main research findings

This study has identified ...

This study has shown that ...

The research has also shown that ...

The second major finding was that ...

These experiments confirmed that ...

X made no significant difference to ...

This study has found that generally ...

The investigation of X has shown that ...

The results of this investigation show that ...

X, Y and Z emerged as reliable predictors of ...

Multiple regression analysis revealed that the ...

The most obvious finding to emerge from this study is that ...

The relevance of X is clearly supported by the current findings.

One of the more significant findings to emerge from this study is that ...

c) Suggesting implications for the field of knowledge

In general, therefore, it seems that ...

The results of this study indicate that ...

These findings suggest that in general ...

The findings of this study suggest that ...

Taken together, these results suggest that ...

An implication of this is the possibility that ...

The evidence from this study suggests that ...

Overall, this study strengthens the idea that ...

The current data highlight the importance of ...

The findings of this research provide insights for ...

The results of this research support the idea that ...

These data suggest that X can be achieved through ...

The theoretical implications of these findings are unclear.

The principal theoretical implication of this study is that ...

This study has raised important questions about the nature of ...

The following conclusions can be drawn from the present study ...

Taken together, these findings suggest a role for X in promoting Y.

The findings of this investigation complement those of earlier studies.

These findings have significant implications for the understanding of how ...

Although this study focuses on X, the findings may well have a bearing on ...

d) Explaining the significance of the findings or contribution of the study

The findings will be of interest to ...

This thesis has provided a deeper insight into ...

The findings reported here shed new light on ...

The study contributes to our understanding of ...

These results add to the rapidly expanding field of ...

The contribution of this study has been to confirm ...

Before this study, evidence of X was purely anecdotal.

This project is the first comprehensive investigation of ...

The insights gained from this study may be of assistance to ...

This work contributes to existing knowledge of X by providing ...

This is the largest study so far documenting a delayed onset of ...

Prior to this study it was difficult to make predictions about how ...

The analysis of X undertaken here, has extended our knowledge of ...

The empirical findings in this study provide a new understanding of ...

This paper contributes to recent historiographical debates concerning ...

This approach will prove useful in expanding our understanding of how ...

This new understanding should help to improve predictions of the impact of ...

This is the first report on X from a nationally representative cohort of patients.

The methods used for this X may be applied to other Xs elsewhere in the world.

The X that we have identified therefore assists in our understanding of the role of ...

This is the first study of substantial duration which examines associations between ...

The findings from this study make several contributions to the current literature. First,...

These findings contribute in several ways to our understanding of X and provide a basis for ...

This study The present study	lays the groundwork for future research into ... provides the first comprehensive assessment of ... establishes a quantitative framework for detecting ... adds to the growing body of research that indicates ... is the only empirical investigation into the impact of ... has been one of the first attempts to thoroughly examine ... appears to be the first study to compare the experiences of ... has gone some way towards enhancing our understanding of ... has confirmed the findings of Smith et al. (2001) which found that...
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e) Recognising the limitations of the current study

A limitation of this study is that ...

Being limited to X, this study lacks ...

The small sample size did not allow ...

The major limitation of this study is the ...

This study was limited by the absence of ...

X makes these findings less generalisable to ...

Thirdly, the study did not evaluate the use of ...

It is unfortunate that the study did not include ...

The scope of this study was limited in terms of ...

The study is limited by the lack of information on ...

The most important limitation lies in the fact that ...

The main weakness of this study was the paucity of ...

Since the study was limited to X, it was not possible to ..

An additional uncontrolled factor is the possibility that ...

It was not possible to assess X; therefore, it is unknown if ...

An issue that was not addressed in this study was whether...

The generalisability of these results is subject to certain limitations. For instance, ...

One source of weakness in this study which could have affected the measurements of X was ...

f) Acknowledging limitation(s) whilst stating a finding or contribution

Notwithstanding these limitations, the study suggests that ...

Whilst this study did not confirm X, it did partially substantiate ...

Despite its exploratory nature, this study offers some insight into ...

In spite of its limitations, the study certainly adds to our understanding of the ...

Notwithstanding the relatively limited sample, this work offers valuable insights into ...

Although the current study is based on a small sample of participants, the findings suggest ...

g) Making recommendations for further research work

The question raised by this study is ...

The study should be repeated using ...

This would be a fruitful area for further work.

Several questions still remain to be answered.

A natural progression of this work is to analyse ...

More research using controlled trials is needed to ...

More broadly, research is also needed to determine ...

A further study could assess the long-term effects of ...

What is now needed is a cross-national study involving ...

Considerably more work will need to be done to determine ...

The precise mechanism of X in insects remains to be elucidated.

These findings provide the following insights for future research: ...

Large randomised controlled trials could provide more definitive evidence.

This research has thrown up many questions in need of further investigation.

A greater focus on X could produce interesting findings that account more for ...

The issue of X is an intriguing one which could be usefully explored in further research.

If the debate is to be moved forward, a better understanding of X needs to be developed.

I suggest that before X is introduced, a study similar to this one should be carried out on ...

More information on X would help us to establish a greater degree of accuracy on this matter.

Further	work needs to be done to establish whether ... studies need to be carried out in order to validate ... studies regarding the role of X would be worthwhile. experimental investigations are needed to estimate ... work is needed to fully understand the implications of ... research is required to establish the therapeutic efficiency of ... modelling work will have to be conducted in order to determine ... investigation and experimentation into X is strongly recommended. experiments, using a broader range of Xs, could shed more light on ... research in other Xs is, therefore, an essential next step in confirming ...
Further research	might explore ... could usefully explore how ... should focus on determining ... is required to determine whether ... in this field would be of great help in ... should be carried out to establish the ... should be undertaken to explore how ... on these questions would be a useful way of ... needs to examine more closely the links between X and Y.

	could also be conducted to determine the effectiveness of ...
--	---

h) Setting out recommendations for practice or policy

Other types of X could include: a), b). ...

There is, therefore, a definite need for ...

Greater efforts are needed to ensure ...

Provision of X will enhance Y and reduce Z.

Another important practical implication is that ...

Moreover, more X should be made available to ...

The challenge now is to fabricate Xs that contain ...

Unless governments adopt X, Y will not be attained.

These findings suggest several courses of action for ...

A reasonable approach to tackle this issue could be to ...

Continued efforts are needed to make X more accessible to ...

The findings of this study have a number of practical implications.

There are a number of important changes which need to be made.

Management to enhance bumble-bee populations might involve ...

This study suggests that X should be avoided by people who are prone to ...

A key policy priority should therefore be to plan for the long-term care of ...

This information can be used to develop targetted interventions aimed at ...

Taken together, these findings do not support strong recommendations to ...

Ensuring appropriate systems, services and support for X should be a priority for ...

The findings of this study have a number of important implications for future practice.

G. General language functions

a) Being Cautious

Devices that distance the author from a proposition

It is thought that ...

It is believed that ...

It has been reported that ...

It is a widely held view that ...

It has commonly been assumed that ...

According to Smith (2002), ...

According to recent reports, ...

According to many in the field ...

Many scholars hold the view that ...

Smith (2001) holds the view that ...

Recent research has suggested that ...

There is some evidence to suggest that ...

Being cautious when giving explanations

These frequent storms	may be could be might be are almost certainly		due to climate change.
It may be It is likely It could be It is possible It is probable It is almost certain		the more extreme weather	is a result of climate change.
A likely explanation A probable explanation A possible explanation	is that	these frequent storms	are a result of climate change.

Being cautious when explaining results

This inconsistency may be due to ...

This discrepancy could be attributed to ...

A possible explanation for this might be that ...
This rather contradictory result may be due to ...
It seems possible that these results are due to ...
The observed increase in X could be attributed to ...
The possible interference of X cannot be ruled out ...
There are several possible explanations for this result.
There are two likely causes for the differences between ...
A possible explanation for these results may be the lack of adequate ...
Since this difference has not been found elsewhere it is probably not due to ...

Advising cautious interpretation of results

(Also refer to [Discussing Findings](#))
These findings cannot be extrapolated to all patients.
These data must be interpreted with caution because ...
These results therefore need to be interpreted with caution.
These results do not rule out the influence of other factors in ...
This account must be approached with some caution because ...
It is important to bear in mind the possible bias in these responses.
Although exclusion of X did not ..., these results should be interpreted with caution.
However, with a small sample size, caution must be applied, as the findings might not be ...

Being cautious when discussing implications

The findings of this study suggest that ...
One possible implication of this is that ...
Taken together, these results suggest that ...
The evidence from this study suggests that ...
Initial observations suggest that there may be a link between ...
The data reported here appear to support the assumption that ...
The findings from these studies suggest that X can have an effect on ...

Being cautious when discussing recommendations

Strategies to enhance X might involve ...
Other types of response could include: a), b). ...
These results would seem to suggest that the ...
There would therefore seem to be a definite need for ...
A reasonable approach to tackle this issue could be to ...
Another possible area of future research would be to investigate why ...

Being cautious when writing about the future

Severe weather	may could might is likely to will probably will almost certainly	become more common in the future.
It is likely It is possible It is almost certain There is a possibility There is a small chance There is a strong possibility	(that) the situation will improve in the long term.	

Devices for avoiding over-generalisation

In general, this requires ...

In general terms, this means ...

Xs use generally accepted principles to ...

X is generally assumed to play a role in ...

Authors generally place an emphasis on ...

Generally accepted methods for X include: ...

Studies which show no effect are not generally published.

Research articles generally consist of the following components:

Quantitative research is generally associated with the positivist paradigm.

Ozone tends to attack cells and break down tissues.

There is a tendency for ozone to attack cells.

Ozone levels	often generally frequently sometimes occasionally nearly always	exceed WHO levels in many cities.
Ozone is toxic to	most almost all some types of many types of the majority of certain types of	living organisms.

b) Being Critical

Highlighting inadequacies of previous studies

Previous studies of X have not dealt with ...

Researchers have not treated X in much detail.

Such expositions are unsatisfactory because they ...

Most studies in the field of X have only focused on ...

Such approaches, however, have failed to address ...

Previous published studies are limited to local surveys.

Half of the studies evaluated failed to specify whether ...

The research to date has tended to focus on X rather than Y.

Previously published studies on the effect of X are not consistent.

Smith's analysis does not take account of ..., nor does she examine ...

The existing accounts fail to resolve the contradiction between X and Y.

Most studies of X have only been carried out in a small number of areas.

However, much of the research up to now has been descriptive in nature ...

The generalisability of much published research on this issue is problematic.

Research on the subject has been mostly restricted to limited comparisons of ...

However, few writers have been able to draw on any systematic research into ...

Short-term studies such as these do not necessarily show subtle changes over time ...

Although extensive research has been carried out on X, no single study exists which ...

However, these results were based upon data from over 30 years ago and it is unclear if ...

The experimental data are rather controversial, and there is no general agreement about ...

Identifying a weakness in a single study or paper

(However,)	Smith fails to fully define what ... Jones fails to acknowledge the significance of ... the author overlooks the fact that X contributes to Y. what Smith fails to do is to draw a distinction between ... the paper would appear to be over-ambitious in its claims. another weakness is that we are given no explanation of how ... no attempt was made to quantify the association between X and Y. the main weakness of the study is the failure to address how ... the study fails to consider the differing categories of damage that ... the research does not take into account pre-existing ... such as ... the author offers no explanation for the distinction between X and Y. Smith makes no attempt to differentiate between different types of X.
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General language functions

Smith The paper The book	fails to does not makes no attempt to	specify ... quantify ... compare ... separate ... account for ... suggest why ... analyse how ... ascertain whether ... distinguish between ... explain the meaning of ... provide information on ... address the question of ... assess the effectiveness of ... use a standardised method of ... give sufficient consideration to ... consider the long term impact of ... offer an adequate explanation for ... engage with current discourses on ... determine the underlying causes of ... systematically review all the relevant literature.
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Offering constructive suggestions

The study would have been more interesting if it had included ...

These studies would have been more useful if they had focused on ...

The study would have been more relevant if the researchers had asked ...

The questionnaire would have been more useful if it had asked participants about ...

The research would have been more relevant if a wider range of X had been explored

A more comprehensive study would include all the groups of ...

A better study would examine a large, randomly selected sample of societies with ...

A much more systematic approach would identify how X interacts with other variables that are believed to be linked to ...

The study The findings Smith's paper Her conclusions	would have been might have been	more far more much more	useful original relevant convincing interesting persuasive	if he/she had if the author had	used ... adopted ... assessed ... included ... addressed ... considered ...
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Introducing problems and limitations: theory or argument

The main weakness with this theory is that ...

The key problem with this explanation is that ...

However, this theory does not fully explain why ...

One criticism of much of the literature on X is that ...

However, there is an inconsistency with this argument.

A serious weakness with this argument, however, is that ...

One question that needs to be asked, however, is whether ...

Smith's argument relies too heavily on qualitative analysis of ...

Smith's interpretation overlooks much of the historical research ...

Many writers have challenged Smith's claim on the grounds that ...

Smith's analysis does not take account of X, nor does he examine ...

It seems that Jones' understanding of the X framework is questionable.

The existing accounts fail to resolve the contradiction between X and Y.

One of the limitations with this explanation is that it does not explain why...

Introducing problems and limitations: method or practice

One major drawback of this approach is that ...

Selection bias is another potential concern because ...

Perhaps the most serious disadvantage of this method is that ...

The main limitation of biosynthetic incorporation, however, is ...

Non-government agencies are also very critical of the new policies.

All the studies reviewed so far, however, suffer from the fact that ...

Critics of laboratory-based experiments contend that such studies ...

Another problem with this approach is that it fails to take X into account.

Difficulties arise, however, when an attempt is made to implement the policy.

Critics have also argued that not only do surveys provide an inaccurate measure of X, but the ...

Nevertheless, the strategy has not escaped criticism from governments, agencies and academics.

However,	this method of analysis has a number of limitations. this method does involve potential measurement error. there are limits to how far the idea of/concept of X can be taken. approaches of this kind carry with them various well known limitations. one of the problems with the instrument the researchers used to measure X was ...
However, all the previously mentioned methods suffer from some serious	drawbacks. limitations. weaknesses. shortcomings. disadvantages.

Using evaluative adjectives to comment on research

In her In their In this	useful	study (of X), survey (of X), analysis (of X), examination (of X), investigation (into X),	Smith (2012) showed that ... Jones (2013) concluded that ...
	timely		
	seminal		
	detailed		
	thorough		
	excellent		
	influential		
	important		
	innovative		
	pioneering		
	impressive		
	wide-ranging		
	comprehensive		
	ground-breaking		

Introducing general criticism

Critics question the ability of poststructuralist theory to provide ...

Non-government agencies are also very critical of the new policies.

Smith's meta-analysis has been subjected to considerable criticism.

The most important of these criticisms is that Smith failed to note that ...

The X theory has been vigorously challenged in recent years by a number of writers.

These claims have been strongly contested in recent years by a number of writers.

More recent arguments against X have been summarised by Smith and Jones (1982):

Critics have also argued that not only do surveys provide an inaccurate measure of X, but the ...

Many analysts now argue that the strategy of X has not been successful. Jones (2003), for example, argues that ...

Introducing the critical stance of particular writers

Jones (2003) has also questioned why ...

However, Jones (2003) points out that ...

The author challenges the widely held view that ...

Smith (1999) takes issue with the contention that ...

The idea that ... was first challenged by Smith (1992).

Smith is critical of the tendency to compartmentalise X.

However, Smith (1967) questioned this hypothesis and ...

Smith (1980) broke with tradition by raising the question of ...

Jones (2003) has challenged some of Smith's conclusions, arguing that ...

Another major criticism of Smith's study, made by Jones (2003), is that ...

Jones (2003) is critical of the conclusions that Smith draws from his findings.

An alternative interpretation of the origins of X can be found in Smith (1976).

Jones (2003) is probably the best known critic of the X theory. He argues that ...

In her discussion of X, Smith further criticises the ways in which some authors ...

Smith's decision to reject the classical explanation of X merits some discussion ...

The latter point has been devastatingly critiqued by Jones (2003), who argues that ...

In a recent article in Academic Journal, Smith (2014) questions the extent to which ...

A recently published article by Smith et al. (2011) casts doubt on Jones' assumption that ...

Other authors (see Harbison, 2003; Kaplan, 2004) question the usefulness of such an approach.

c) Classifying and Listing

Classifying a topic

X can be classified into Xi and Xii.

X can be categorised into Xi, Xii and Xiii.

Several taxonomies for X have been developed ...

Different methods have been proposed to classify ...

X may be divided into several groups: a) ..., b) ... or c) ...

Generally, X provides two types of information: Xi and Xii.

It has become commonplace to distinguish 'Xi' from 'Xii' forms of X.

X is generally classified into two types: Xi, also known as ..., and Xii or ...

There are two basic approaches currently being adopted in research into X. One is ...

The theory distinguishes two different types of X, i.e. social X and semantic X (Smith, 2013).

The works of Smith fall under three headings: (1) dialogues and ..., (2) collections of facts, and ...

X may be divided into	three main		classes. sub-groups. categories.
X may be classified	on the basis of according to depending on in terms of	Y	into Xi and Xii.

Describing a specific system of classification

Smith (2015) draws a distinction between ...

Smith (2006) categorised X as being a) ..., b) ..., or c) ...

Smith's (1980) typology of X is the one most widely-used.

Jones (1987) distinguishes between systems that are a) ..., b) ..., or c) ...

A third method, proposed by Smith et al. (2010), bases the classification on a ...

To better understand X, Smith et al. (2011) classified Y into three distinct types using ...

For Smith, X is of four kinds: (1) X which ...; (2) X which ...; (3) X which ...; and (4) X which...

In Jones's system, individuals were classified as belonging to upper or lower categories of ...

Smith's Taxonomy is a classification system used to define and distinguish different levels of ...

Smith and Jones (2003) argue that there are two broad categories of Y, which are: a) ..., and b) ...

In the traditional system, X is graded		in terms of ... on the basis of ... according to whether ...	
Smith (1966)		divided classified grouped	Xs into two broad types: Xi's and Xii's.
Thomas (1996) describes	four basic kinds of validity:	logical, content, criterion and construct.	

Commenting on a system of classification

This system of classification	includes ... allows for ... helps distinguish ... is useful because ... is very simple and ... provides a basis for ... can vary depending on ... was agreed upon after ... has been broadened to include ... was developed for the purpose of ... is more scientific since it is based on ...
	is now out of date. can be problematic. is in need of revision. poses a problem for ... has limited utility with respect to ...

Introducing lists

This topic can best be treated under three headings: X, Y and Z.

The key aspects of management can be listed as follows: X, Y and Z.

There are three reasons why the English language has become so dominant. These are:

There are two types of effect which result when a patient undergoes X. These are ...

The disadvantages of the new approach can be discussed under three headings, which are: ...

The Three Voices for Mass is divided into six sections. These are: the Kyrie, Gloria,

Appetitive stimuli have three separable basic functions. Firstly, they ... Secondly, they ...

During his tour of Britain, he visited the following industrial centres: Manchester, Leeds, and ...

This section has been included for several reasons: it is ...; it illustrates ...; and it describes...

The Mass for Four Voices consists of five movements, which are: the Kyrie, Gloria, Credo, Santus and Agnus Dei.

Referring to other people's lists

Smith and Jones (1991) list X, Y and Z as the major causes of infant mortality.

Smith (2003) lists the main features of X as follows: it is X; it is Y; and it has Z.

Smith (2003) argues that there are two broad categories of Y, which are: a) ... and b) ...

For Aristotle, motion is of four kinds: (1) motion which ...; (2) motion which ...; (3) motion ...

Smith (2003) suggests three conditions for X. Firstly, X should be ... Secondly, it needs to be ...

d) Compare and Contrast

Introducing differences

X is different from Y in a number of respects.

X differs from Y in a number of important ways.

There are a number of important differences between X and Y.

Areas where significant differences have been found include X and Y.

In contrast to earlier findings, however, no evidence of X was detected.

A descriptive case study differs from an exploratory study in that it uses ...

Jones (2013) found dramatic differences in the rate of decline of X between Y and Z.

Women and men differ not only in physical attributes but also in the way in which they ...

The nervous systems of Xs are significantly different from those of Ys in several key respects.

Smith (2003)	found observed	major notable distinct only slight significant considerable	differences between X and Y.
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Introducing similarities

Both X and Y share a number of key features. There are a number of similarities between X and Y. The effects of X on human health are similar to those of Y. Both X and Y generally take place in a 'safe environment'. These results are similar to those reported by (Smith et al. 1999). This definition is similar to that found in (Smith, 2001) who writes:

The return rate is similar to that of comparable studies (e.g. Smith et al. 1999). The approach used in this investigation is similar to that used by other researchers. Studies have compared Xs in humans and animals and found that they are essentially identical.

The mode of processing used by the right brain	is similar to that is comparable to that is comparable in complexity to that	used by the left brain.
--	---	-------------------------

Comparing within one sentence

Oral societies tend to be more concerned with the present	whereas while	literate societies have a very definite awareness of the past.
Whereas While	oral societies tend to be more concerned with the present,	literate societies have a very definite awareness of the past.
This interpretation	differs from that contrasts with that is different from that	of Smith and Jones (2004) who argue that
In contrast to oral communities,	it is very difficult to get away from calendar time in literate societies.	
Compared with people in oral cultures,	people in literate cultures organise their lives around clocks and calendars.	

Comparing within one sentence: comparative forms

In the trial, women made more/fewer errors than men.

Women tend to have greater/less verbal fluency than men.

Women are more/less likely than men to perform well in tests.

Women are more/less accurate in tests of target-directed motor skills.

Women tend to perform better/worse than men on tests of perceptual speed.

Women are faster/slower than men at certain precision manual tasks, such as ...

Women are more/less likely to suffer from X when the front part of the brain is damaged.

The part of the brain connecting the two hemispheres may be more/less extensive in women.

Indicating difference across two sentences

It is very difficult to get away from calendar time in literate societies.	By contrast, In contrast, On the other hand,	many people in oral communities have little idea of the calendar year of their birth.
--	--	---

Indicating similarity across two sentences

Young children learning their first language need simplified input.	Similarly, Likewise, In the same way,	low level adult L2 learners need graded input supplied in most cases by a teacher.
---	---	--

e) Defining Terms

Introductory phrases

The term 'X' was first used by ...

The term 'X' can be traced back to ...

Previous studies mostly defined X as ...

The term 'X' was introduced by Smith in her ...

Historically, the term 'X' has been used to describe ...

It is necessary here to clarify exactly what is meant by ...

This shows a need to be explicit about exactly what is meant by the word 'X'.

A university is	an institution	where knowledge is produced and passed on to others
Social Economics may be defined as	the branch of economics	[which is] concerned with the measurement, causes, and consequences of social problems.
Research may be defined as	a systematic process	which consists of three elements or components: (1) a question, problem, or hypothesis, (2) data, and (3) analysis and interpretation of data.
Braille is	a system	of touch reading and writing for blind people in which raised dots on paper represent the letters of the alphabet.

General meanings or application of meanings

The term 'X' refers to ...

X can broadly be defined as ...

X can be loosely described as ...

The term 'X' encompasses A), B), and C).

X can be defined as ... It encompasses ...

The term 'X' has come to be used to refer to ...

The term 'X' is generally understood to mean ...

In the literature, the term tends to be used to refer to ...

In broad terms, X can be defined as any stimulus that is ...

Whereas X refers to the operations of ..., Y refers to the ...

The broad use of the term 'X' is sometimes equated with ...

The term 'X' has been used to refer to situations in which ...

The term 'disease' refers to a biological event characterised by ...

The term 'X' is a relatively new name for a Y, commonly referred to as ...

Defined as X, obesity is now considered a worldwide epidemic and is associated with ...

Indicating varying definitions

The definition of X has evolved.

There are multiple definitions of X.

Several definitions of X have been proposed.

In the field of X, various definitions of X are found.

The term 'X' embodies a multitude of concepts which ...

This term has two overlapping, even slightly confusing meanings.

Widely varying definitions of X have emerged (Smith and Jones, 1999).

Despite its common usage, X is used in different disciplines to mean different things.

Since the definition of X varies among researchers, it is important to clarify how the term is ...

The meaning of this term	has evolved.
	has varied over time.
	has been extended to refer to ...
	has been broadened in recent years.
	has not been consistent throughout ...
	has changed somewhat from its original definition ...

Indicating difficulties in defining a term

X is a contested term.

X is a rather nebulous term ...

X is challenging to define because ...

A precise definition of X has proved elusive.

A generally accepted definition of X is lacking.

Unfortunately, X remains a poorly defined term.

There is no agreed definition on what constitutes ...

There is little consensus about what X actually means.

There is a degree of uncertainty around the terminology in ...

These terms are often used interchangeably and without precision.

Numerous terms are used to describe X, the most common of which are

The definition of X varies in the literature and there is terminological confusion.

Smith (2001) identified four abilities that might be subsumed under the term 'X': a) ...

'X' is a term frequently used in the literature, but to date there is no consensus about ...

X is a commonly-used notion in psychology and yet it is a concept difficult to define precisely.

Although differences of opinion still exist, there appears to be some agreement that X refers to ...

Specifying terms that are used in an essay or thesis

The term 'X' is used here to refer to ...

In the present study, X is defined as ...

The term 'X' will be used solely when referring to ...

In this essay, the term 'X' will be used in its broadest sense to refer to all ...

In this paper, the term that will be used to describe this phenomenon is 'X'.

In this dissertation, the terms 'X' and 'Y' are used interchangeably to mean ...

Throughout this thesis, the term 'X' is used to refer to informal systems as well as ...

While a variety of definitions of the term 'X' have been suggested, this paper will use the definition first suggested by Smith (1968) who saw it as ...

Referring to people's definitions: author prominent

For Smith (2001), X means ...

Smith (2001) uses the term 'X' to refer to ...

Smith (1954) was apparently the first to use the term ...

In 1987, psychologist John Smith popularized the term 'X' to describe ...

According to a definition provided by Smith (2001:23), X is 'the maximally ...

This definition is close to those of Smith (2012) and Jones (2013) who define X as ...

Smith, has shown that, as late as 1920, Jones was using the term 'X' to refer to particular ...

One of the first people to define nursing was Florence Nightingale (1860), who wrote: '... ...'

Chomsky writes that a grammar is a 'device of some sort for producing the' (1957, p.11).

Aristotle defines the imagination as 'the movement which results upon an actual sensation.'

Smith et al. (2002) have provided a new definition of health: 'health is a state of being with ...

Referring to people's definitions: author non-prominent

X is defined by Smith (2003: 119) as '... ...'

The term 'X' is used by Smith (2001) to refer to ...

X is, for Smith (2012), the situation which occurs when ...

A further definition of X is given by Smith (1982) who describes ...

The term 'X' is used by Aristotle in four overlapping senses. First, it is the underlying ...

X is the degree to which an assessment process or device measures ... (Smith et al., 1986).

Commenting on a definition

This definition	includes ...
-----------------	--------------

	allows for ... highlights the ... helps distinguish ... takes into account ... poses a problem for ... will continue to evolve. can vary depending on ... was agreed upon after ... has been broadened to include ...
The following definition is	intended to ... modelled on ... too simplistic: useful because ... problematic as ... inadequate since ... in need of revision since ... important for what it excludes. the most precise produced so far.

f) Describing Trends

Describing trends

The graph shows that there has been a Figure 2 reveals that there has been a	slight steep sharp steady gradual marked	fall rise drop decline increase decrease	in the number of divorces in England and Wales since 1981.
---	---	---	--

Highlighting a trend in a table or chart

What is striking What stands out What is interesting What can be clearly seen	in this	table chart figure	is the growth of ... is the high rate of ... is the variability of ... is the dominance of ... is the rapid decrease in ... is the steady decline of ... is the general pattern of ... is the dramatic decline in ... is the continual growth of ... is the difference between ...
--	---------	--------------------------	---

			is the phenomenal growth of ...
--	--	--	---------------------------------

Describing high and low points in figures

Production of X peaked in 1985.

X rose to a high point and peaked in ...

The peak age for committing a crime is 18.

The number of Xs reached a peak during ...

Production of X reached a low point in 1990.

The rate fell to a low point of \$5.00 at the end of the year.

Projecting trends

The rate of Z The amount of Y The number of Xs	is likely to will probably is expected to is projected to	fall fall reach ... rise to ... increase level off decline by ... drop sharply remain steady be as high as ... decline steadily continue decreasing grow by more than ...	after 2020.
--	--	---	-------------

g) Describing Quantities

Describing fractions

Over half of those surveyed indicated that ...

Nearly half of the respondents (48%) agreed that ...

Approximately half of those surveyed did not comment on ...

Less than a third of those who responded (32%) indicated that ...

The number of first marriages in the United Kingdom fell by nearly two-fifths.

Of the 148 patients who completed the questionnaire, just over half indicated that ...

Well over More than Just over Many more than Around Almost	half a third a quarter	of those surveyed of the respondents of those who responded	agreed that ...
---	------------------------------	---	-----------------

As many as			
Approximately			
Just under			
Less than			
Fewer than			
Well under			

Describing proportions

Singapore has the highest proportion of millionaire households.

The annual birth rate dropped from 44.4 to 38.6 per 1000 per annum.

The proportion of live births outside marriage reached one in ten in 1945.

Scotland had the lowest proportion of lone parents at only 14 per cent.

The proportion of the population attending emergency departments was 65% higher in X than ...

Describing percentages

70% of those who were interviewed indicated that ...

Since 1981, England has experienced an 89% increase in crime.

The response rate was 60% at six months and 56% at 12 months.

In 1960 just over 5% of live births in 1960 were outside marriage.

Returned surveys from 34 radiologists yielded a 34% response rate.

He also noted that fewer than 10% of the articles included in his study cited ...

With each year of advancing age, the probability of having X increased by 9.6% ($p = 0.006$).

The mean income of the bottom 20 percent of U.S. families declined from \$10,716 in 1970 to ...

X found that of 2,500 abortions, 58% were in young women aged 15-24, of whom 62% were ...

Well over			
More than			
Just over			
Many more than			
Around	40%	of those surveyed	
Almost	50%	of the respondents	
Approximately	80%	of those who responded	agreed that ...
Just under			
Less than			
Fewer than			
Well under			

Describing averages

The average of 12 observations in the X, Y and Z is 19.2 mgs/m ...

This figure can be seen as the average life expectancy at various ages.

The proposed model suggests a steep decline in mean life expectancy ...

Roman slaves probably had a lower than average life expectancy.

The mean age of Xs with coronary atherosclerosis was 48.3 ± 6.3 years.

Mean estimated age at death was 38.1 ± 12.0 years (ranging from 10 to 60+ years)

The mean score for X was subjected to multivariate analysis of variance to determine ...

The mean income of the bottom 20 percent of U.S. families declined from \$10,716 in 1970 to ...

Describing ranges

Estimates of X range from 200,000 to 700,000 and up to a million or more.

The respondents had practised for an average of 15 years (range 6 to 35 years).

The participants were aged 19 to 25 and were from both rural and urban backgrounds.

Rates of decline ranged from 2.71–0.08 cms per day with a mean of 0.97 cms per day.

They calculated ranges of journal use from 10.7%–36.4% for the humanities, 25%–57% for ...

The evidence shows that life expectancy from birth lies in the range of twenty to thirty years.

At between 575 and 590 metres depth, the sea floor is extremely flat, with an average slope of ...

The mean income of the bottom 20 percent of U.S. families declined from \$10,716 to \$9,833.

h) Explaining Causality

Verbs indicating causality

Lack of protein	may cause can lead to can result in	mental disability.
Scurvy is a disease	caused by resulting from stemming from	lack of vitamin C.
Much of the instability in X	stems from	the economic effects of the war.
Low levels of chlorine	can give rise to	high blood pressure.

Verbs indicating contributive agency

X has contributed to the decline in ...

It is now understood that X plays an important role in ...

A number of factors play a role in determining the effects of ...

The mixing of X and Y exerts a powerful effect upon Z through...

Recent research has revealed that X has a detrimental effect on ...

A number of factors are known to affect the volume and type of ...

All these factors can impact on the efficiency and effectiveness of ...

X is only one of many factors that help to determine the quality of

Several factors are known to	affect X. shape X.
------------------------------	-----------------------

	predict X. increase X. influence X. determine X. affect the rate of ... be associated with ... increase the risk of ... be partially responsible for ... play a role in determining X .
--	--

Nouns indicating causality

One reason why Xs have declined is that ...

A consequence of vitamin A deficiency is blindness.

The causal role of X in Y has been demonstrated by ...

The most likely causes of X are poor diet and lack of exercise.

The causes of X have been the subject of intense debate within ...

X can have profound health consequences for older people.

Physical activity is an important factor in maintaining fitness.

Many other medications have an influence on cholesterol levels.

Nouns indicating contributive agency

X is a key factor in ...

X is a major influence on ...

X has a positive effect on ...

X has a significant impact on ...

X is an important determinant of ...

X and Y are important driving factors of Z.

X is generally seen as a factor strongly related to Y.

X is a significant contributory factor to the development of ...

This work has revealed several factors that are responsible for ...

The study found that loneliness has twice the impact on early death as obesity does.

X is a/an	risk common dominant predictive important significant underlying contributing confounding complicating	factor	in ... for....
-----------	--	--------	----------------------------

Prepositional phrases indicating causality

200,000 people per year become deaf	owing to because of as a result of as a consequence of	a lack of iodine.
-------------------------------------	---	-------------------

Sentence connectors indicating causality

If undernourished children do survive to become adults, they have decreased learning ability.	Therefore, Consequently, Because of this, As a result (of this),	when they grow up, it will probably be difficult for them to find work.
---	---	---

Adverbial elements indicating causality

Malnutrition leads to illness and a reduced ability to work in adulthood, The warm air rises above the surface of the sea,	thus thereby	perpetuating the poverty cycle. creating an area of low pressure.
---	-----------------	--

Expressing a causal relationship tentatively

X may have been an important factor in ...

X may have contributed to the increase in ...

X may have played a vital role in bringing about ...

X may have been caused by an increase in ...

In the literature, X has been associated with Y.

A high consumption of X could be associated with infertility.

X in many cases may be associated with certain bacterial infections.

There is some evidence that X may affect Y.

It is not yet clear whether X is made worse by Y.

This suggests a weak link may exist between X and Y.

The use of X may be linked to behaviour problems in ...

The human papilloma virus is linked to most cervical cancer.

The findings indicate that regular exercise could improve cognitive function in people at risk of ...

i) Giving Examples

Examples as the main information in a sentence

A/An	well-known notable classic useful important	example of X is
------	---	-----------------------

For example, the word 'doctor' used to mean a 'learned man'.

For example, Smith and Jones (2004) conducted a series of semi-structured interviews in ...

Young people begin smoking for a variety of reasons. They may, for example, be influenced by

This is exemplified in the work undertaken by ...

Another example of what is meant by X is ...

This distinction is further exemplified in studies using ...

An example of this is the study carried out by Smith (2004) in which ...

The effectiveness of the X technique has been exemplified in a report by Smith et al. (2010)

This is evident in the case of ...

This is certainly true in the case of ...

The evidence of X can be clearly seen in the case of ...

In a similar case in America, Smith (1992) identified ...

This can be seen in the case of the two London physics laboratories which ...

X is a good illustration of ...

X illustrates this point clearly.

This can be illustrated briefly by ...

By way of illustration, Smith (2003) shows how the data for ...

These experiments illustrate that X and Y have distinct functions in ...

Examples as additional information

Young people begin smoking for a variety of reasons, such as pressure from peers or ...

The prices of resources, such as copper, iron ore, and aluminium, have declined over ...

Pavlov found that if a stimulus, for example the ringing of a bell, preceded the food, the ...

Many diseases can result at least in part from stress, including: arthritis, asthma, and migraine.

Gassendi kept in close contact with many other scholars, such as Kepler, Galileo, Descartes, and ...

Reporting cases as support

This case has shown that ...

This has been seen in the case of ...

The case reported here illustrates the ...

Overall, these cases support the view that ...

This case study confirms the importance of ...

The evidence presented thus far supports the idea that ...

This case demonstrates the need for better strategies for ...

As this case very clearly demonstrates, it is important that ...

This case reveals the need for further investigation in patients with ...

This case demonstrates how X used innovative marketing strategies in ...

Recent cases reported by Smith et al. (2013) also support the hypothesis that ...

In support of X, Y has been shown to induce Y in several cases (Smith et al., 2001).

j) Signalling Transition

Previewing sections of text

The section below describes ...

What follows is an account of ...

In the following pages, I will present ...

The following is a brief description of ...

In the section that follows, it will be argued that ...

The problem of X is discussed in the following section.

A more detailed account of X is given in the following section.

The structure and functions of X will be explained in the following section.

The following part of this paper moves on to describe in greater detail the...

Introducing a new topic

Regarding X, ...

As regards X, ...

In terms of X, ...

In the case of X ...

With regard to X, ...

With respect to X, ...

On the question of X, ...

As far as X is concerned, ...

Reintroducing a topic

As discussed above, ...

As explained earlier, ...

As previously stated, ...
As indicated previously ...
As described on the previous page, ...
As was mentioned in the previous chapter, ...
Returning (briefly) to the (subject/issue) of X, ...
As explained in the introduction, it is clear that ...
As was pointed out in the introduction to this paper, ...

Moving from one section to the next

Turning now to ...
Let us now turn to ...
Let us now consider ...
Moving on now to consider ...
Turning now to the experimental evidence on ...
Before proceeding to examine X, it is important to ...
Before explaining these theories, it is necessary to ...
Having defined what is meant by X, I will now move on to discuss ...
So far this paper has focused on X. The following section will discuss ...
This chapter has demonstrated that ... It is now necessary to explain the course of ...
Having discussed how to construct X, the final section of this paper addresses ways of ...
This section has analysed the causes of X and has argued that ... The next part of this paper will ...

Moving from one section to the next, indicating addition or contrast

Another significant aspect of X is ...
In addition, it is important to ask ...
Unlike Smith, Jones (2014) has argued ...
In contrast to Smith, Jones (2014) maintains ...
Despite this, little progress has been made in the ...
However, this system also has a number of serious drawbacks.
On the other hand, in spite of these recent findings about the role of ...,

Summarising a section or chapter

Thus far, the thesis has argued that ...
The previous section has shown that ...
To conclude this section, the literature identifies ...
This section has reviewed the three key aspects of ...
In summary, it has been shown from this review that ...

This chapter has described the methods used in this investigation and it has ...

This section has attempted to provide a brief summary of the literature relating to ...

This chapter began by describing X and arguing that ... It went on to suggest that the ...

In this section, it has been explained that ... The chapter that follows moves on to consider the...

Previewing a following chapter

In the chapter that follows, I present ...

The next chapter describes the synthesis and evaluation of ...

A summary of the main findings, together with ..., is provided in the next chapter.

The next chapter describes the procedures and methods used in this investigation ...

In the next section, I will present the principal findings of the current investigation ...

These analytical procedures and the results obtained from them are described in the next chapter.

k) Writing about the Past

Time phrases associated with the use of the simple past tense: specific times or periods of time in the past

During the Nazi period, Between 1933 and 1945, From 1933 to 1945, In the 1930s and 1940s,	restrictions were placed on German academics.
For centuries, In the second half of the 19th century, At the end of the nineteenth century,	church authorities placed restrictions on academics.
Following World War I, In 1999,	Fleming actively searched for anti-bacterial agents. Fleming was named one of the 100 Most Important People of the century.

Time phrases associated with the use of the present perfect tense: past and present connected

To date, little evidence has been found associating X with Y.

Up to now, the research has tended to focus on X rather than on Y.

So far, three factors have been identified as being potentially important: X, Y, and Z.

Since 1965, these four economies have doubled their share of world production and trade.

Until recently, there has been little interest in X.

Recently, these questions have been addressed by researchers in many fields.

In recent years, researchers have investigated a variety of approaches to X but ...

More recently, literature has emerged that offers contradictory findings about ...

The past decade has seen the rapid development of X in many ...

Over the past 30 years there has been a significant increase in ...

Over the past century there has been a dramatic increase in ...

Over the past few decades, the world has seen the stunning transformation of X, Y and Z.

The present perfect tense may also be used to describe research or scholarly activity that has taken place recently

Several studies have revealed that ...

Previous studies of X have not dealt with ...

A considerable amount of literature has been published on X.

There have been several investigations into the causes of illiteracy (Smith, 1985; Jones, 1987).

The new material has been shown to enhance cooling properties (Smith, 1985, Jones, 1987).

Invasive plants have been identified as major contributing factors for the decline of ...

The relationship between a diet high in fats and poor health has been widely investigated (Smith, 1985, Jones, ...

For reference to single investigations or publications in the past, the simple past tense is used

An experimental demonstration of this effect was first carried out by ...

The first experimental realisation of ..., by Smith et al. [12], used a ...

The first systematic study of X was reported by Patel et al. in 1986.

Smith and Jones (1994) were the first to describe X, and reported that ...

X as originally isolated from Y in a soil sample from ... (Wang et al., 1952).

In 1975, Smith et al. published a paper in which they described ...

In the 1950s, Gunnar Myrdal pointed to some of the ways in which ...

In 1981, Smith and co-workers demonstrated that X induced in vitro resistance to ...

In 1984, Jones et al. made several amino acid esters of X and evaluated them as ...

In 1990, Patel et al. demonstrated that replacement of H₂O with heavy water led to ...

Thirty years later, Smith (1974) reported three cases of *Candida Albicans* which ...